



## AFTER

Lincoln's Preliminary Emancipation Proclamation, issued after the Battle of Antietam, doomed Confederate hopes for international recognition.

### CONFLICTING BRITISH CONCERNS

In the short term, the war's bloody outcome concerned the British government, which wished to **end the bloodshed in North America for humanitarian reasons**, but in the long term, it would be difficult for any British government to side with slavery against freedom.

### CSS ALABAMA

Some tensions between Northerners and Britain would persist until after the war, especially in relation to the destruction of Union merchant shipping by the Confederate commerce raiders that had been built in British shipyards.

Massachusetts senator Charles Sumner famously declared after the war that **Great Britain should compensate the United States** for the damages inflicted by the most famous Confederate commerce raider, *CSS Alabama*, by giving it the territory of Canada. In the end, Britain paid compensation instead.

Built in Britain and commissioned in 1862 after being armed and fitted out in Portugal's Azores Islands, **the *Alabama* never visited any Confederate ports in its two-year career**. It raided Union shipping around the world, capturing or destroying 65 Union vessels without loss of life on either side. The ship was brought to battle off Cherbourg, France, in 1864, and **sunk by USS *Kearsarge*** (see [The Duel of the \*Alabama\* and the \*Kearsarge\*](#)).